

AAN ONLINE COMMUNITY GUIDELINES

African AI Network (AAN)

This policy is reviewed periodically, and any updates will be published on the AAN website, effective upon posting. For significant changes, we may notify you directly via the eHub or email.

1. PURPOSE

1.1. This appendix outlines the standards of behavior and ethical guidelines expected from learners when engaging in online and hybrid learning environments associated with AAN. It aims to:

1.1.1. Promote a culture of academic integrity, digital safety, and collaborative ethics.

1.1.2. Establish clear expectations for appropriate conduct and respectful communication across all AAN platforms. 1.1.3. Protect the rights and contributions of all learners, particularly in group work and collaborative projects.

1.2. This document serves as a simplified, printable reference for the full **AAN Code Of Conduct**. While it provides a useful summary, the full policy remains the official comprehensive source for all disciplinary matters.

2. SCOPE

2.1. This appendix applies to all learners and contributors engaging within:

2.1.1. **Learning Management Systems:** e.g. AEEP, Canvas, or AAN internal portals.

2.1.2. **Community Platforms:** e.g., AAN Communities, .

2.1.3. **Engagement Tools:** e.g., Zoom, Microsoft Teams, Slack, Discord, YouTube, Telegram, WhatsApp, Slido, and Kahoot

3. GENERAL PRINCIPLES

3.1. **Academic Integrity:** We take the authenticity of work seriously. Do not copy or plagiarize internet content or the work of peers. Always reference sources. If you use AI to generate material, you **must** cite it clearly.

3.2. **Cultural Awareness:** Respect the diverse backgrounds of the AAN community. Avoid assumptions or generalizations.

3.3. **No Spamming:** Do not post promotional content or aggressive self-promotion.

3.4. **Legality:** Do not post content that is illegal or promotes unlawful activities.

3.5. **Digital Inclusivity:** AAN is a safe space free from cyberbullying and digital abuse. 3.6. **AI for Good:** Commit to using AI tools ethically to improve workflows and support peers.

4. COLLABORATIVE INTEGRITY & GROUP WORK

To ensure integrity in team settings, the following are prohibited:

4.1. **Unauthorized Use:** Pitching or repurposing team projects without clear permission from all original contributors.

4.2. **Misattribution:** Claiming shared group work as individual milestones or solo portfolio pieces.

4.3. **Exclusion:** Continuing a team project independently without informing or involving original collaborators.

4.4. **Asset Misuse:** Using group-created code, designs, or ideas in external settings without attribution.

5. QUICK REFERENCE: DO'S AND DON'TS

Based on AAN's **CHAIR Values** (Courage, Humility, Adventure, Initiative, Integrity, Resilience).

Category	Do's	Don'ts (Unacceptable)
Respect & Inclusion	Treat everyone with kindness; be inclusive.	Harass, troll, bully, or use discriminatory language.
Academic Honesty	Submit original work; credit all sources and AI tools.	Plagiarize from the internet, peers, or past learners.
Professionalism	Use your real name and a clear photo on your profile.	Impersonate others or disrupt the learning flow.

Digital Etiquette

Post in the correct channels;
provide context for links.

Spam channels or share
copyrighted material/external
group links.

Community

Share feedback and support
peers generously.

Dismiss questions or
discourage new learners.

6. VIOLATIONS

Violations of these guidelines may lead to corrective action as outlined in the **AAN Learner Code of Conduct**. Actions include:

- Official written warnings.
- Temporary suspension from digital platforms.
- Permanent removal from the AAN program.
- Escalation to legal authorities where local laws are breached.

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